

Thomas J. Hughes

George Mason University
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EDUCATION:

Ph.D., Economics (ABD), George Mason University, Fairfax, VA Expected 2027
M.A., Economics, George Mason University, Fairfax, VA 2025
B.A., Mathematics and Economics, Mercer University, Macon, GA 2023
Minor: Statistics; Certificate: Actuarial Science

Fields: Political Economy; Applied Microeconomics; Austrian Economics; Economic Sociology

FELLOWSHIPS AND AFFILIATIONS:

PhD Fellowship, Mercatus Center 2023 – present
Graduate Fellow, F.A. Hayek Program for Advanced Study in Philosophy,
Politics, and Economics, Mercatus Center 2023 – present
Network Member, Initiative for the Study of a Stable Peace 2024 – present

PROFESSIONAL WORK:

Graduate Lecturer, George Mason University 2026 – present
Intermediate Microeconomics (ECON 306), one section
Graduate Teaching Assistant – Instructor of Record, George Mason University 2025 – 2026
Contemporary Macroeconomic Principles (ECON 104), four sections
Course Evaluations: Fall 2025: [Section 004](#); [Section 008](#)
Spring 2026: [Section 001](#); [Section 010](#)
Graduate Research Assistant, George Mason University 2023 – 2025; 2026 – present
Assistant for Christopher J. Coyne (2023–2025, 2026–2027) and Peter J. Boettke (Summer 2024)
Preceptor, Mercer University 2020 – 2021
Calculus 1 preceptor classes, Department of Mathematics, four sections

ACADEMIC PUBLICATIONS:

1. Journal Articles

"Bureaucratic Control After *Loper Bright Enterprises v. Raimondo*: The Rise of Judicial Control in a Post-Chevron Deference World," *Journal of Public Finance and Public Choice*, 2026. doi: <https://doi.org/10.1332/25156918Y2026D000000031>

2. Under Review

"The Weapon Itself is the Threat: Nuclear Weapons, the Knowledge Problem, and Normal Accidents," under review at *Cosmos + Taxis*. (with C. Coyne)

"The Budget-Maximizing Peacemaker: The Success Paradox of Peace-Through-Strength Defense Policy," under review at *Public Choice*.

3. Working Papers

"Does Government-Nonprofit Contracting Instantiate Democratic Priority-Setting?" (with B. Mandeville)

4. Works in Progress

"Centripetal and Centrifugal Forces in Single-Dimensional Computational Spatial Voting Models" (with R. Ragan)

"Doctoral Failure: A Subjectivist Model of Exploitative Medical Behavior under Moral Constraints"

"When Truth Can Be Bad for Business: A Theory of Expert Failure in Religious Leadership" (with R. Koppl)

"William Niskanen and the Economics of Bureaucracy: Theory, Influence, and Policy Legacy"

5. Books and Monographs in Progress

The Machinery of Administration: Bureaucracy in Mainline Economics. (with C. Coyne)

HONORS AND AWARDS:

Young Scholar, Association for Private Enterprise Education	2026
Student Fellow of the Public Choice Society	2026
Outstanding Award in Research, Stetson-Hatcher School of Business, Mercer University	2023
Center for the Study of Economics and Liberty Research Grant, Mercer University	2023

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE:

Referee: *Journal of Public Finance and Public Choice*

INVITED ACADEMIC PRESENTATIONS:

Mercer University, Center for the Study of Economics and Liberty Macon, Georgia. "Peace Doesn't Pay: The Success Paradox of Defense Bureaucracy"	September 2026
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CONFERENCES:

Association of Private Enterprise Education Meeting, Las Vegas, NV Presented: "The Budget-Maximizing Peacemaker" & "The Weapon Itself is the Threat"	April 2026
Public Choice Society, San Antonio, TX Presented: "The Budget-Maximizing Peacemaker"	March 2026
Southern Economic Association, Tampa, FL Presented: "Bureaucratic Control After <i>Loper Bright</i> " & "Doctoral Failure"	November 2025
Markets and Society Conference, Falls Church, VA Presented: "The Weapon Itself is the Threat"	October 2025
Society of Business, Industry, and Economics, Destin, FL Presented: "Centripetal and Centrifugal Forces in Spatial Voting Models"	April 2023

REFERENCES:

Christopher Coyne Department of Economics, George Mason University	ccoyne3@gmu.edu
Peter Boettke Department of Economics, George Mason University	pboettke@gmu.edu
Rosolino Candela Mercatus Center at George Mason University	rcandela@mercatus.gmu.edu
Robi Ragan Department of Economics, Mercer University	ragan_ra@mercer.edu